

User:

I just had an idea, and I know that I have not updated this book idea or expanded on it in a while now, but I just had an idea, which was based off of some reading that I was doing about how God died for our sins. He came down and died. And it was a parallel to when Moses lifted up the golden snake for the people of Israel, and all they had to do was look at the golden snake to be healed. It was a simple act of faith. It was something that signified that there was nothing they could do except submit and look to God, which is directly foreshadowing what Jesus did, that we are all sinners bitten by sin, and the only remedy is looking towards God. And my thought is that the character in this book can be trying to do all these things to overcome his sin, striving, striving, striving, but at the end of the book, what he finds is that the little oasis that he was first woke up by, that had a tree, that had water, that had food, and safety, was what he was supposed to look for this entire time. And he keeps venturing out, looking for different ways to escape and different ways to get out of this wilderness that he thinks he's in. And the moment that he actually just sits, takes in the oasis, which is not a real oasis, it's like a whatever the actual version of an oasis is, where there's actual, like, a pool of water that is like life, a source of life in the middle of a desert. Whenever he embraces that that's where he needs to stay, and that that's where he needs to be, and that's where he needs to put his effort and his gaze, the end of the book ends where he actually closes his eyes, opens them, and he's actually in a room that he recognizes in the real world. And the room has younger pictures of him from a few years back. He realizes he's sitting in a chair for disabled people. And he realizes he can't, he can barely move his arms, and he can only think and see. And I'm not sure how disabled he would be when he wakes up, but essentially, the ending would be that he has been in a coma. He has been living in his imagination for the last few years, while caretakers and his family were feeding him, praying for him, being there for him, and that he had actually been put into this coma through some sort of tragic situation, like a car accident or a blunt hit to the head. And the story ends with basically him understanding and realizing that striving for freedom, striving for the answer, it doesn't get him anywhere, but just simply recognizing that God is there is the answer. Maybe he's not disabled after a little while. Maybe he does gain his life back. But like, that could be a life-changing moment for him and it is a paradigm shift for how he chooses to live the rest of his life on the real earth. I'm wondering how... How I would bring into the story the underlying theme that the whole dream and this whole purpose of this thing was to show him by God that the sin he was trapped in can only be beaten and only be overcome by living close to the source of life instead of just running from the sin and finding a solution. And I want to be very like subtle with the fact that maybe it was sexual sin, something like cheating on his wife and how that messed up his family. Maybe after the coma, maybe it literally has been five years and his wife has moved on. But maybe there could be a scene at the end where he gets to talk to his daughter or son, maybe it's his son, because of the generational aspect of this, but maybe his wife and son come to see him and his wife who basically had taken full custody of his son, allows him to be back in his dad's life. And there's a mutual understanding that through the last five years, both of them have had a work in their life, and the wife could have been remarried, and the husband understands that she needs to leave, that she needed to leave, and there's redemption there.

Assistant:

(This response discussed themes like striving vs. looking, the oasis metaphor, subtle storytelling, coma reveal, and redemption dynamics in detail.)